



Employee User Manual

South African HR and Payroll Platform

Your self-service guide to NovaHR

Employee Role

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1. What the Employee role can do

Employee

Your role in NovaHR

As an employee you have a personal, self-service workspace. You can view your own profile, manage your leave requests, download your payslips, and look up basic information about your colleagues. Your salary, banking details, and personal information are never visible to other employees.

What you can do

- View and edit your own profile details
- Check your leave balances for all leave types
- Submit leave requests with supporting documents
- Track the status of your leave requests
- View and download your monthly payslips
- Complete your onboarding checklist
- Upload a profile photo

What you cannot see

- Other employees' salaries or banking details
- Other employees' payslips or tax numbers
- Company-wide payroll totals
- PAYE, UIF, or SDL return records
- Other employees' leave balances
- Settings (contact your HR administrator)

2. Accepting your invitation and logging in

Your HR administrator sends you an invitation by email

- 1 Check your email** for a message from NovaHR with the subject "You have been invited to [Company Name]". Click the *Accept invitation* button in the email. The link is valid for 7 days.
- 2 Set your password** on the accept-invite page. Your name and email are already filled in from the invitation. Choose a strong password (at least 8 characters) and click *Join workspace*.
- 3 You are immediately signed in** and taken to your personal dashboard. Bookmark **novahr-five.vercel.app** for future logins.



Returning to NovaHR: Go to **novahr-five.vercel.app** and sign in with your email address and the password you set during the invite process. If you forget your password, click *Forgot password* on the login page to receive a reset email.



If you did not receive an invitation email, ask your HR administrator to check Settings > Users and resend the invite, or to copy the invite link and send it to you directly via WhatsApp or your company email.

3. Understanding your personal dashboard

Your at-a-glance overview every time you sign in

The screenshot shows the NovaHR personal dashboard for user Aisha. The interface includes a sidebar navigation menu (1) with links to Dashboard, My Profile, My Payslips, and Leave. The main content area features a greeting (2) and a welcome message. Below this are four summary cards: Annual leave left (12 days, 3), Latest payslip net pay (R 50,356.59, 3), Monthly gross salary (R 79,166.67, 4), and Time at NovaTech (7 yrs, 5). The 'My profile' section (6) displays user details and a 'View full profile' link. The 'Leave balances' section (7) shows progress bars for Annual leave (12/18), Sick leave (28/30), Family responsibility (2/3), and Unpaid leave (5/5), with a 'Request leave' button. The 'My payslips' section (8) provides a link to view and download past payslips. The 'Leave requests' section (9) offers a link to track the status of time off. At the bottom left, the user's name, role badge, and sign-out option are displayed (10).

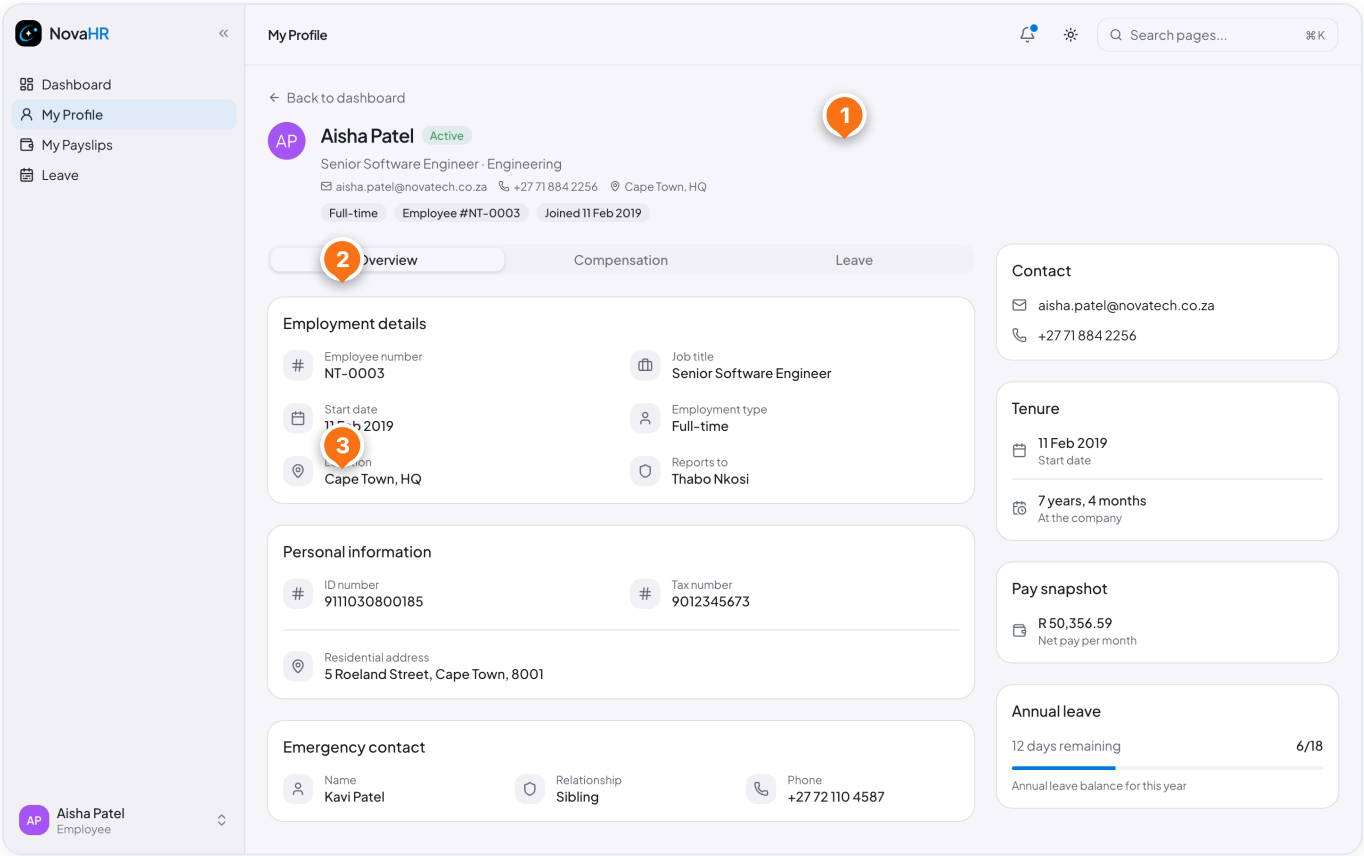
- | | |
|---|--|
| 1 Navigation: Dashboard, My Profile, My Payslips, Leave | 2 Annual leave remaining for the year |
| 3 Latest payslip net pay amount | 4 Your monthly gross salary |
| 5 Time at the company (years of service) | 6 Your profile summary card with manager and employment type |
| 7 Leave balances with progress bars (days used vs. total) | 8 My payslips shortcut |
| 9 Leave requests shortcut | 10 Your name, role badge, and sign-out option |



The leave balance card on the right side of your dashboard shows your remaining days at a glance. The progress bar goes from green (plenty of leave remaining) to orange (low balance). Click **Request leave** directly from the dashboard to submit a new request.

4. Viewing your profile

Your personal, job, and contact details



- 1 Profile photo: click to upload a new photo (JPG or PNG)

3 Job information: title, department, manager, and start date
- 2 Personal information: name, contact details, and address

Go to **My Profile** in the sidebar to view all of your details. As an employee you can update certain fields yourself:

Information	Can you edit it?
Profile photo	Yes: click the camera icon on your avatar
Phone number	Yes: click the edit icon next to the field
Home address	Yes
Emergency contact	Yes
Job title, department, salary	No: contact HR to make these changes
Email address (login)	No: contact HR to update
SA ID number	No: contact HR if there is an error
Banking details	No: contact HR to update

If any details on your profile are incorrect, for example a wrong ID number or salary, contact your HR administrator by email or in person. They can update these from the employee management section.

5. Completing your onboarding checklist

Your new-starter tasks to complete in your first weeks

When you first join NovaHR your profile may have an **Onboarding** status badge. Your HR administrator has set up a checklist of tasks for you to complete. Go to **My Profile** and scroll down to the Onboarding section.

- 1 **Find the onboarding checklist** on your profile page. It shows tasks like "Submit signed contract", "Upload copy of ID", or "Complete bank details confirmation".
- 2 **Tick each task** once you have completed it. Click the checkbox next to the item; it saves automatically.
- 3 **Upload your profile photo** by clicking the camera icon on your avatar at the top of the profile page. A clear headshot is recommended.
- 4 Once all items are ticked, your status changes from **Onboarding** to **Active**.



Your progress percentage is visible in the employee directory (to HR and your manager) so completing the checklist quickly shows that you have settled into the onboarding process.

6. Viewing your leave requests

NovaHR

Dashboard

My Profile

My Payslips

Leave

Leave

My Leave

Track your leave balance and request time off.

Pending requests

0

Awaiting review

On leave today

0

Out of 1 employees

Approved this period

1

2 days total

Declined this period

0

Requests rejected

Requests

Balances

Policies

Public holidays

All statuses

All types

Employee	Type	Dates	Days	Reason	Doc	Status
AP Aisha Patel Engineering	Sick leave	10 Jun 2026 to 11 Jun 2026	2	Flu, doctor's note attached.		Approved

AP

Aisha Patel

Employee

- 1

Request leave button to submit a new request
- 2

Tab navigation: Requests, Balances, Policies, Public holidays
- 3

Your leave history: type, dates, working days, and status
- 4

Status badge: Pending (orange), Approved (green), Rejected (grey)

Go to **Leave** in the sidebar to see all of your leave requests. The list shows every request you have submitted, sorted with the most recent at the top.

Pending requests show a yellow/orange badge. Once your manager or HR approves or rejects, the badge updates and you receive a notification in the bell icon at the top of the page.

7. Checking your leave balances

NovaHR

<<

Dashboard

My Profile

My Payslips

Leave

Leave

My Leave

Track your leave balance and request time off.

Pending requests

0

Awaiting review

On leave today

0

Out of 1 employees

Approved this period

1

2 days total

Declined this period

0

Requests rejected

Requests

Balances

Policies

Public holidays

Employee	Annual	Sick	Family	Study	Unpaid
AP Aisha Patel Engineering	12 left	6/1828 left	2/302 left	1/35 left	0/55 left

AP

Aisha Patel

Employee

Click the **Balances** tab on the Leave page. This shows your current remaining days for each leave type. The progress bar turns orange when your balance is running low.

Leave type	What it means for you
Annual leave	Paid holiday; you are entitled to 18 working days per year
Sick leave	30 working days over a 36-month cycle (roughly 10 per year)
Family responsibility	3 days per year for family emergencies
Study leave	5 days per year for examinations or study commitments
Unpaid leave	5 discretionary days per year; your pay is deducted for these days

Maternity, parental, adoption, and commissioning leave entitlements are handled separately as one-off events. They do not appear as ongoing balances. If you are planning any of these, speak to HR who will guide you through the process.

8. Requesting leave

How to submit a leave request in under 2 minutes

The screenshot shows the 'Request leave' form in the NovaHR system. The form is titled 'Request leave' and includes the following fields and options:

- Employee:** Aisha Patel - Senior Software Engineer
- Leave type:** Annual leave (indicated by a red circle with the number 1)
- Start date:** 2026/07/02
- End date:** 2026/07/02 (indicated by a red circle with the number 2)
- Annual leave balance:** 11 days available (1 day requested, 11 days left after)
- Reason:** Add a short note for the approver (indicated by a red circle with the number 3)
- Attach supporting document:** Optional. JPEG, PNG or PDF up to 10 MB.
- Buttons:** Cancel and Submit request (indicated by a red circle with the number 4)

- 1 Choose the type of leave (see list below)
- 2 Select start and end dates; working days are counted automatically
- 3 Add a reason and optionally attach a document
- 4 Submit request button

- 1 **Click Request leave** at the top right of the Leave page, or use the button on your dashboard.
- 2 **Select the leave type.** Leave types are grouped into Standard (annual, sick, family responsibility), Family and parental (maternity, parental, adoption, commissioning), and Other (study, unpaid). A description of each type and its statutory basis appears below the dropdown when you select it.
- 3 **Choose your start and end dates.** The form automatically counts the number of working days in your chosen range, excluding weekends and South African public holidays. The count appears below the date fields. The form will not let you submit a request where the working-day count is zero (for example if you select only a weekend).
- 4 **Add a reason.** Keep it brief, for example "Medical appointment" or "Family holiday". This note goes to your manager and HR for the approval decision.
- 5 **Attach a supporting document (optional).** For sick leave lasting more than 2 days, most employers require a medical certificate. Click *Attach supporting document* and upload a JPEG, PNG, or PDF (maximum 10 MB).
- 6 **Click Submit request.** Your manager (and HR) receive an email notification. The request appears in your leave list immediately with a Pending badge.



Once your leave is approved, your balance is automatically reduced by the number of working days. You receive an email confirmation and a notification in the NovaHR app.



Submitting a request **does not automatically approve it**. You must wait for your manager or HR to approve before treating the time as confirmed leave. If you have not heard back within a day or two, follow up with your manager directly.

9. Leave types and entitlements

Leave type	BCEA entitlement	Who approves	Pay during leave
Annual	18 working days/year	Manager or HR	Full salary
Sick	30 days per 36 months	HR	Full salary
Family responsibility	3 days/year	Manager or HR	Full salary
Maternity	4 months (88 days)	HR	UIF benefit (apply at SARS)
Parental	10 consecutive days	HR	UIF benefit
Adoption	10 weeks (child under 2)	HR	UIF benefit
Commissioning parental	10 weeks	HR	UIF benefit
Study	5 days/year (company policy)	Manager or HR	Full salary
Unpaid	5 days discretionary	HR	No pay; deducted from gross



Click the **Policies** tab on the Leave page to read the full description of each leave type, including the specific BCEA section that governs it.

10. Viewing your payslips

Access every monthly payslip you have ever received

Dashboard

My Profile

My Payslips

Leave

My Payslips

View and download your past payslips.

Latest net pay
R 50,356.59
July 2026

Monthly gross
R 79,166.67
Current salary

Year to date
R 338.7K
7 payslips

Next pay date
25 Aug 2026
August 2026

Payslip history

Period	Pay date	Gross	Net	
July 2026	25 Jul 2026	R 79,166.67	R 50,356.59	
June 2026	25 Jun 2026	R 79,166.67	R 50,356.59	
May 2026	25 May 2026	R 79,166.67	R 47,603.38	
April 2026	25 Apr 2026	R 79,166.67	R 47,603.38	
March 2026	25 Mar 2026	R 79,166.67	R 47,603.38	
February 2026	25 Feb 2026	R 79,166.67	R 47,603.38	
January 2026	25 Jan 2026	R 79,166.67	R 47,603.38	

AP Aisha Patel
Employee

1 List of all payslips: period, pay date, gross, net. Click any row to view or download.

- 1 Click My Payslips in the sidebar navigation.
- 2 Find the **payslip** you want in the list. Payslips are listed by period (most recent first) and show the gross and net pay.
- 3 Click the **payslip row** to open the detailed view with all earnings and deductions listed.
- 4 Click **Download PDF** to save a branded payslip to your device for bank applications, rental agreements, or any other purpose that requires proof of income.

Payslip PDFs are branded with your company logo and look professional for third-party submissions such as home loan applications or visa income requirements.

11. Understanding your payslip

What each line on your payslip means

Payslip line	What it means
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Basic salary	Your monthly gross before any deductions
Travel allowance	Monthly travel allowance (80% taxable unless you have a logbook)
Housing allowance	Fixed monthly housing benefit (fully taxable)
Unpaid leave deduction	Amount deducted for any unpaid leave taken this month
Gross earnings	Total earnings before deductions
PAYE	Income tax calculated by SARS tax tables; withheld by your employer
UIF (employee)	1% of gross up to R177.12/month; funds unemployment benefits
Pension contribution	Your elected % of gross into your retirement fund (tax-deductible)
Medical aid tax credit	Monthly credit applied against PAYE for medical aid membership
Net pay	The amount deposited into your bank account on pay day



If you believe your PAYE is too high or your net pay is incorrect, check that your ID number and medical aid dependant count are correctly recorded on your profile. These directly affect your tax calculation. If in doubt, speak to your HR administrator.



Your employer also pays **UIF employer (1%)** and **SDL (1%)** on top of your gross. These do not appear as deductions from your take-home pay but are visible on the full payslip detail.

12. Looking up a colleague

Dashboard
My Profile
My Payslips
Leave

My Profile

AP

Aisha Patel

Active

Senior Software Engineer - Engineering
aisha.patel@novatech.co.za +27 71 884 2256 Cape Town, HQ
Full-time Employee #NT-0003 Joined 11 Feb 2019

Overview

Compensation

Leave

Employment details

Employee number
NT-0003

Job title
Senior Software Engineer

Start date
11 Feb 2019

Employment type
Full-time

Location
Cape Town, HQ

Reports to
Thabo Nkosi

Personal information

ID number
9111030800185

Tax number
9012345673

Residential address
5 Roeland Street, Cape Town, 8001

Emergency contact

Name
Kavi Patel

Relationship
Sibling

Phone
+27 72 110 4587

Contact

aisha.patel@novatech.co.za
+27 71 884 2256

Tenure

11 Feb 2019
Start date

7 years, 4 months
At the company

Pay snapshot

R 50,356.59
Net pay per month

Annual leave

12 days remaining

6/18

Annual leave balance for this year

Go to **Employees** in the sidebar to see the company directory. As an employee you can see:

- Names, job titles, and departments of all active colleagues
- Email addresses and phone numbers (to contact colleagues)
- Employment type and office location

You **cannot** see salaries, banking details, ID numbers, or leave balances of other employees.

Employee Quick Reference

Task	Where to go
Check remaining annual leave	Dashboard (right panel) or Leave > Balances tab
Submit a leave request	Leave > click Request leave (top right)
Check the status of a request	Leave > Requests tab
Download your latest payslip	My Payslips > click most recent row > Download PDF
Update your phone number or address	My Profile > click the edit icon next to the field
Upload a profile photo	My Profile > click the camera icon on your avatar
Complete onboarding checklist	My Profile > scroll to Onboarding section
Look up a colleague's contact	Employees (directory)
Reset your password	Login page > Forgot password

Annual leave: key facts

- ✓ You are entitled to 18 working days of annual leave per year
- ✓ Weekends and SA public holidays are not counted in your leave days
- ✓ Annual leave must be approved before it is taken
- ✓ Leave taken during a public holiday does not use an annual leave day for that day
- ✓ Unused annual leave does not automatically pay out; speak to HR about any carryover policy

Getting help

If something is wrong or you need help with NovaHR, speak to your HR administrator. They are your first point of contact for any account issues, balance corrections, or questions about your payslip.

For platform support, email: mtshwenewesley@gmail.com